

FOR THE TEACHER

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

Lead Your AI Squad — why the capstone works, an exemplar quest card, coaching the three roles, and the taught/assessed standards map.



WHY THIS LESSON

This is the unit's final boss, and it's deliberately a rerun. The **quest card** is Lesson 1's P.R.O. framework grown up; the **accuracy check** is Lesson 3's fact-desk habit; the **taste check** is Lesson 4's feedback eye; choosing what to hand the squad is Lesson 5's boring-work sort. Students aren't learning four new skills — they're discovering that the four they already have make them a leader. New to the unit? It stands alone: every skill is re-taught in miniature. For the adults in the room: a quest card is what work calls a brief or a spec, and this loop is delegation — the same one your students will one day use to run real projects and real AI agents. "Party leader" is simply the version of that job every 12-year-old already understands.

EXEMPLAR QUEST CARD (ZINE ISSUE #1)

GOAL: a first issue of the class zine that makes other 6th graders want to submit their own work. **WHAT WE KNOW:** 8 photocopied pages; we already have 3 comics and 2 poems from classmates. **RULES OF THE RUN:** school-appropriate, every page credits a student by name, done by Friday. **DONE LOOKS LIKE:** a page-by-page plan plus a rough cover sketch.

How to score any quest card: hand it to the most literal reader in the room. If they can twist it, or have to guess, a part is missing or vague. All four parts, specific = proficient.

COACHING THE THREE ROLES

Planner — good output is a numbered step list with time guesses, plus "NOT ON THE CARD" flags where the quest card is silent. Those flags are gold: they're the next card's fixes.

Scout — good output is a fact list where every item is marked ✓ verified (with where) or ? needs checking. A "fact" with no source is a guess wearing a costume — run it back.

Critic — good output is 3 upgrades tied to the audience the card names ("6th graders won't read 40 words of rules — cut to 15"). Vague praise doesn't count.

Enforce the silence. When a party member asks a question mid-round, answer: "It's not on the card." The frustration is the point — vague quest cards fail in public, and students feel exactly why leaders write better ones. Don't rescue a weak card; the review makes the failure visible and fixable.

👍 RUNNING THE ROOM (WHAT-IFS)

Class doesn't divide by 3? A team of 4 runs two critics (they'll disagree — great). A team of 2 drops the critic; the leader does the taste check personally.

A leader turns harsh? The note requires KEEP before FIX, and the leader reads it aloud to their party member. Feedback you say to a face stays fair.

A team finishes early? Rewrite the quest card so tight the critic can't land a note — or design a fourth squad role.

EXEMPLAR RUN-IT-BACK NOTE (SHARE AFTER ROUND 1)

KEEP: "The schedule works and the title is big and readable, exactly like the card asked." **FIX:** "The flyer says 'games all night' — Game Night ends at 8 pm. Fix the time, then re-check every fact against the card." *A specific fact, a specific fix — nobody guesses.*

SCORING THE EXIT TICKET

- **Proficient:** all four parts labeled, specific enough that a stranger could do the task tomorrow.
- **Developing:** parts present but vague ("make it good," "soon").
- **Beginning:** a wish, not a quest card ("help me with math").

FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **ISTE 1.5.c** — Students break problems into component parts, extract key information, and develop descriptive models to understand complex systems or facilitate problem-solving. *Taught: Party Leader's Loop instruction (four card parts + role split). Assessed: Quest Card builder, worksheet p.1.*
- **ISTE 1.7.c** — Students contribute constructively to project teams, assuming various roles and responsibilities to work effectively toward a common goal. *Taught: Run the Quest team activity (every student works a role AND leads a review). Assessed: role-card output + CHECK rubric and run-it-back note, worksheet p.2.*
- **CCSS ELA W.6.4** — Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. *Taught: quest-card modeling in direct instruction. Assessed: Exit Ticket quest card, worksheet p.2.*

SUPPORT: QUEST CARD SENTENCE STARTERS

GOAL: "When this quest is done, ____ will happen." · **WHAT WE KNOW:** "This is for _____. The team already has _____."

RULES OF THE RUN: "It must _____. It must NOT _____. Due _____." · **DONE LOOKS LIKE:** "Hand back a _____ (flyer / list / plan / paragraph)."

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